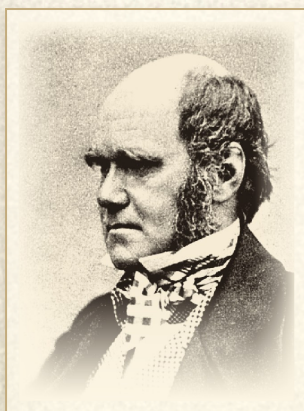




# CHARLES DARWIN

1809 – 1882

Naturalist · Geologist · Author

*Ask questions. Discover the truth.*

## READ THE TEXT

*Paragraph numbers help you find the answers.*

- 1** Charles Darwin (1809–1882) was a British scientist who studied nature and animals during the Victorian era. He was born in Shrewsbury, England, and died in Kent.
- 2** Darwin grew up in a wealthy family. His father, a doctor, hoped Charles would follow the same path, but Charles was far more drawn to nature than to his studies. At university he showed little interest in his lessons, preferring instead to explore the natural world and collect beetles and birds. Much of what he learned came not from textbooks but from his own observations and curiosity.
- 3** Adventurous by nature, Darwin loved exploring rainforests and climbing mountains in search of new plants and animals. At the age of 22, he joined a voyage around the world that lasted five years — a journey that would go on to change the course of science.
- 4** Through his observations during and after the voyage, Darwin developed the theory of evolution, proposing that all living things, including humans, share common ancestors. It was a radical idea for its time, offering an answer to a question that had long puzzled naturalists: how do species change over time? His theory reshaped the way people understood the natural world.
- 5** Later in life, Darwin married his cousin Emma, and together they had children.
- 6** Today, Darwin's theory remains a cornerstone of modern science and is taught in schools around the world, having fundamentally changed how we understand nature.

## WORDS TO KNOW

**nature** – plants, animals and everything in the natural world

**beetle** – a small insect with hard wings

**observation** – watching something carefully to learn about it

**ancestor** – someone who lived a long time before you

**wealthy** – having a lot of money

**voyage** – a long journey by ship

**evolution** – the slow change of plants and animals over a very long time

**species** – a group of animals or plants of the same kind

*“Much of what he learned came from his own observations and curiosity.”*

**1 TRUE, FALSE OR NOT GIVEN***Circle T, F or NG.*

1. Charles Darwin was born in England.
2. Darwin's father wanted him to become a doctor too.
3. Darwin was a very good student at university.
4. At university Darwin collected beetles and birds.
5. Darwin's brother travelled with him on the voyage.
6. The voyage around the world lasted five years.
7. Darwin was 22 years old when he joined the voyage.
8. Darwin married a woman he had never met before.

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**2 FILL IN THE GAPS***Use the words in the box.*

ANCESTORS   BEETLES   COUSIN   DOCTOR   EVOLUTION   MOUNTAINS   NATURE  
VOYAGE

1. Charles Darwin studied \_\_\_\_\_ and animals.
2. His father was a \_\_\_\_\_.
3. At university Darwin collected \_\_\_\_\_ and birds.
4. He loved exploring rainforests and climbing \_\_\_\_\_.
5. At the age of 22 he joined a \_\_\_\_\_ around the world.
6. Darwin developed the theory of \_\_\_\_\_.
7. He proposed that all living things share common \_\_\_\_\_.
8. Later in life Darwin married his \_\_\_\_\_ Emma.

**3 ANSWER THE QUESTIONS***Write full sentences.*

1. Where was Charles Darwin born?

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.....

2. What did Darwin's father hope his son would become?

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.....

3. What did Darwin collect instead of studying his lessons?

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.....

4. How old was Darwin when he joined the voyage around the world?

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.....

5. What did Darwin's theory say about all living things?

.....  
.....

6. Who did Darwin marry?

.....  
.....

**4 MATCH THE TWO HALVES***Write a, b, c, d or e.*

1. ☐ Darwin's father was a doctor and hoped

a. lasted five years.

2. ☐ At university Darwin was more interested in nature

b. that Charles would follow the same path.

3. ☐ The voyage around the world

c. is taught in schools around the world.

4. ☐ Darwin's theory says that humans and animals

d. than in his lessons.

5. ☐ Today Darwin's theory

e. share common ancestors.

**5 NEW FOR THE BOARD***Not on your board yet – add these three.***THREE QUESTIONS TO ADD FOR CHARLES DARWIN**

**400** Who joined a voyage around the world at the age of 22?

**600** What is the name of Darwin's famous theory?

**800** Who did Charles Darwin marry?